

Jared L. Smith

He/Him | jaredlavernesmith@gmail.com | [Access My Portfolio](#) | [Access My LinkedIn](#)

GIS analyst and urban development researcher with five years of event and operations management experience. Seeking to leverage skills in spatial data analysis, policy research methods, project management, and stakeholder communication to build equitable cities for all residents.

Education

M.A. in Sustainable Urban Development | DePaul University **June 2026**

Specializations: Urban Planning Policy Research and Analysis; Data Visualization and Analysis

Graduate Certificate in Geographic Informational Systems | DePaul University **June 2026**

Specializations: Spatial Analysis for Community Development; Python for GIS Scripting

B.A. in Media, B.A. in Theatre and Drama | Indiana University - Bloomington **May 2018**

Specializations: Project Management; Stakeholder Communication; Public Speaking & Presentation

Publications

Hwang, S., Maniar, P. C., **Smith, J.**, & Nivens, K. (2026). False Alerts Related to GPS Electronic Monitoring in Illinois Cook County Sheriff's Office. *Criminal Justice Review*, doi: 10.1177/07340168261428124.

Research Experience

Tree Canopy Density and Urban Heat, Air Quality, and Land Use in Pilsen **September 2025 - November 2025**

Public Health GIS Project | Mi Villita Neighbors & DePaul University

- Partnered with Mi Villita Neighbors to examine the relationship between tree canopy density, land use, and public health indicators in Pilsen
- Implemented spatial autocorrelation tests to identify clusters of high and low tree canopy density within the study area
- Analyzed land use in significant tree canopy clusters and identified disparities in canopy density between Pilsen and other residential areas
- Managed LiDAR data to map Pilsen's current tree canopy, creating an educational tool for Mi Villita's outreach work

False Alerts Related to GPS Electronic Monitoring in Illinois **February 2025 - June 2025**

Research Paper and Spatial Data Analysis Project | DePaul University, Department of Geography and GIS

- Investigated the relationship between GPS tracking errors and false alerts in Cook County's electronic monitoring program
- Employed GeoPandas to organize ~555,000 individual building heights, generating a dataset that calculated the average building height for each Chicago zip code
- Geocoded ~10,000 building instances missing critical information by applying spatial join techniques to replace <null> values with the correct zip code
- Conducted three correlation analyses and created six maps to examine the relationship between false alert rates and average building height, building density, and tree canopy density in each Chicago zip code
- Drafted and revised substantial portions of the literature review, methods, results, and discussion sections based on original research findings

Flags, Food, and Faith **August 2024 - January 2025**

GIS and StoryMap Project | City of Chicago: Department of Cultural Affairs and Special Events

- Designed a StoryMap to serve as the online gallery for *Flags, Food, and Faith*: a photography project highlighting 30 Black and Latine owned businesses in under-invested neighborhoods
- Employed ArcGIS Online to develop three interactive maps illustrating economic development data across Chicago's 77 community areas
- Created six graphs visualizing disparities in business ownership rates among Chicago's Latine, POC, and female residents

Welcomed, Empowered, Respected

September 2024 - November 2024

Statistical Analysis Project | DePaul University, School of Public Service

- Analyzed six years of Department Climate Survey data to examine BIPOC and LGBTQ+ student experiences at the School of Public Service
- Developed a statistical index to measure students' sense of "Welcomeness" and applied Cronbach's Alpha to confirm internal consistency
- Conducted T-tests and multiple regression analyses, revealing that BIPOC and LGBTQ+ students reported lower levels of welcomeness than White and heterosexual peers, controlling for other demographic variables
- Utilized Chi-Square tests to identify a significant relationship between BIPOC status and reported experiences of discrimination or harassment at the School
- Authored a research report communicating original findings, which was shared with the Dean of the School

725 - 739 Howard Street Site Proposal

March 2024 - June 2024

Housing Development Project | DePaul University, Sustainable Urban Development Program

- Conducted a site feasibility analysis for a 38-unit mixed-use housing development with subsidized family apartments
- Reviewed zoning, parking, and land-use regulations to ensure compliance with B3-Commercial District standards and to optimize transit-oriented design opportunities
- Developed a subsidy strategy for affordable family apartments by leveraging LIHTC valuation, commercial unit revenue, and market-rate apartment profits to reduce affordable unit prices by ~\$200,000

Single-Residency Occupancy Hotels and Gentrification in Uptown, Chicago

January 2024 – March 2024

Housing Analysis and Policy Report | DePaul University, Sustainable Urban Development Program

- Analyzed land-use, economic, and demographic data to assess the state of transitional and affordable housing
- Evaluated the impact of the 2014 SRO Preservation Ordinance by mapping sales of all SRO Hotels in rent-burdened areas over the past decade
- Interviewed SRO residents and staff, gaining insights into transitional housing living and working conditions
- Investigated affordable housing policy and recommended community-led strategies to prevent displacement from gentrification

Professional Experience

GIS Teaching Assistant

March 2026 - Present

DePaul University, Department of Geography and GIS | Chicago, IL

- Provided tutoring support for a spatial data science class of 13 undergraduate students
- Assist students in their Python assignments, which provide educational guidance and allow students to gain confidence in their coding skills
- Troubleshoot technical questions and provide administrative support to the teacher as needed

Career Fair & Events Coordinator

September 2023 – Present

DePaul University Career Center | Chicago, IL

- Managed production timelines, logistics, and execution for ten career fairs, connecting ~2,000 DePaul students with 150 employers
- Analyzed three years of event feedback survey data to identify trends in event execution and inform event policy
- Redesigned event feedback surveys enhance the quality of data collected from students and alumni
- Coordinated communication campaigns with corporate recruiters and DePaul alumni, expanding the range of organizations attending Career Center events

City Government Intern

May 2024 - January 2025

City of Chicago: Department of Cultural Affairs and Special Events | Chicago, IL

- Coordinated health permits for Taste of Chicago: collaborated directly with other City departments and community stakeholders to ensure 80 local restaurants met public health requirements for three local food festivals
- Directly assisted 30 restaurant owners in navigating the City's special events permit application
- Documented 250 articles of historical program materials to ensure accessibility for internal and public research

- Crafted weekly events reports for eight Aldermanic offices to ensure Alderpersons are informed of the 100+ events happening in their ward
- Processed data for 120+ grant recipients that assisted the Grants Department in their annual financial review

Labor and Logistics Manager

August 2022 - March 2023

AV Chicago | Chicago, IL

- Served as the sole individual responsible for hiring freelance crew members for each company production, successfully staffing over 100 shows
- Onboarded freelance crew members and managed a labor pool of 170 freelancers
- Analyzed labor cost data and prepared budget reports to ensure competitive, sustainable, and equitable labor pricing
- Coordinated daily delivery schedules for a fleet of seven vehicles and four drivers
- Implemented operational procedures to evaluate freelance crew performance

Operations Support Coordinator

February 2022 - August 2022

AV Chicago | Chicago, IL

- Authored over 60 production agendas: documents that communicated an event's scope of work, the client's expectations, call times, and necessary equipment
- Oversaw 60 show budgets, effectively optimizing the client's financial resources to meet desired event outcomes
- Processed over 200 labor invoices and diligently reported production costs in the company's budgeting software
- Assisted with on-the-ground production support during peak busy season

Nonprofit Events and Operations Coordinator

January 2021 - October 2021

Friends of the Parks | Chicago, IL

- Developed, planned, and executed six events that benefited internal and community stakeholders
- Booked a venue, managed vendors, and hired performers for the nonprofit's 45th Anniversary Gala fundraiser
- Coordinated a corporate move, and managed the operational expenses of the new office space
- Connected with community stakeholders to organize park clean-ups on the South and West Side

Technology

GIS: ArcGIS Pro | ArcPy | StoryMaps

Data Analysis: Python (Pandas, GeoPandas) | Microsoft Excel for Statistical Analysis | R (Spatial Analysis)

Project Management: Asana | Microsoft Teams

Graphic Design: Adobe Illustrator | SketchUp | Canva

Communication: Microsoft Word | Microsoft PowerPoint | Zoom

Certifications

CITI Program Certification

December 2024

Stage 1 - Basic Course | Expires December 2027

Honors

Chaddick Scholar

June 2024

Chaddick Institute for Metropolitan Development | Chicago, IL

Professional References

Donyiel Crocker, DePaul University Career Center

Associate Director, Employer Engagement

Current Manager

Jennifer Brown, Chicago Department of Cultural Affairs and Special Events

Cultural Affairs Coordinator II, Operations and Permits

Former Manager

Jocelyn Martinez, DePaul University Career Center

Assistant Director, Student & Employer Connections

Former Manager (now Acquisition Coordinator at AbbVie)